Windows 24x7 Chrome Dashboard Kiosk

Installation, Working & Technical Support Guide

Package version: V4
Platform: Microsoft Windows
Dashboard: https://web.itank.io/login/
Startup method: Current-user HKCU Run entry + VBScript watchdog
Browser: Google Chrome with persistent C:\Kiosk\ChromeProfile

SCOPE	This guide documents the Windows V4 kiosk package: installation, startup behavior, Chrome watchdog operation, diagnostics, removal and common troubleshooting.

1. What This Windows Kiosk Does

The package starts Google Chrome in kiosk/full-screen mode for the IoT dashboard after the Windows kiosk user logs in. A VBScript watchdog remains running and relaunches Chrome if the kiosk Chrome process is closed.

- Windows auto-login is expected before the kiosk startup flow begins; this package does not configure Windows auto-login.
- Startup is registered under the current user in HKCU\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Run.
- The watchdog waits 10 seconds after login before checking and starting Chrome.
- The Chrome profile at C:\Kiosk\ChromeProfile is reused so cookies and dashboard login state can remain available.
- The watchdog checks every 5 seconds whether Chrome is running with the kiosk profile and relaunches it if needed.
- V4 uses VBScript and wscript.exe; PowerShell is not part of the watchdog startup path.

Startup Flow

Step	Component	Practical Behavior
1	Windows boot	Windows starts normally.
2	Windows user login	The intended kiosk account logs in. Automatic login must already be configured if unattended startup is required.
3	HKCU Run	Windows executes wscript.exe "C:\Kiosk\Chrome-Kiosk-Watchdog.vbs" for that user.
4	10-second delay	The watchdog allows Explorer and networking to settle.
5	Chrome kiosk	Chrome opens https://web.itank.io/login/ using the persistent kiosk profile.
6	Watchdog loop	Every 5 seconds the watchdog checks for Chrome using C:\Kiosk\ChromeProfile and relaunches it if missing.

2. Package Contents

File	Purpose
INSTALL-KIOSK-V4.cmd	Installs the watchdog into C:\Kiosk, removes older startup methods, creates the current-user Run entry and starts the kiosk immediately.
Chrome-Kiosk-Watchdog.vbs	Main runtime watchdog. Finds Chrome, starts kiosk mode and relaunches Chrome if the kiosk process is no longer running.

File	Purpose
TEST-KIOSK-V4.cmd	Diagnostic script that shows the current user, startup registry entry, watchdog file, Chrome locations, log and running Chrome command lines.
REMOVE-KIOSK-V4.cmd	Removes the automatic kiosk startup entry and old startup leftovers. It intentionally keeps the Chrome profile.
README-KIOSK-V4.txt	Short package instructions and startup flow reference.

IMPORTANT	Extract the complete ZIP before installation. INSTALL-KIOSK-V4.cmd specifically checks that Chrome-Kiosk-Watchdog.vbs exists beside it.

3. Preparation Before Installation

Requirement	What to Check
Windows user	Use the same Windows account that will run the kiosk. The startup entry is created in HKCU, so it is user-specific.
Google Chrome	Chrome must already be installed. The watchdog does not install Chrome.
Chrome locations	The watchdog checks LocalAppData, Program Files, and Program Files (x86) Google Chrome application folders.
Dashboard access	Confirm https://web.itank.io/login/ is reachable from the Windows PC.
Auto-login	If the device must recover unattended after a reboot, Windows automatic login must be configured separately.
Package	Extract all V4 files into one local folder before running INSTALL-KIOSK-V4.cmd.
Permissions	The installer must be able to create C:\Kiosk and write the current user Run registry value.

Before You Run the Installer

- Confirm you are logged in as the intended kiosk Windows user.
- Confirm Google Chrome opens normally.
- Confirm the dashboard URL opens in Chrome.
- Close any older kiosk/watchdog windows if you are replacing a previous version.
- Keep TEST-KIOSK-V4.cmd and REMOVE-KIOSK-V4.cmd available for support and rollback of startup registration.

4. Installation - Simple Procedure

1. Extract the complete Windows kiosk ZIP to a local folder.
2. Open Command Prompt in that extracted folder, or browse to the folder in File Explorer.
3. Run the installer:

```
INSTALL-KIOSK-V4.cmd
```

4. The installer creates C:\Kiosk and C:\Kiosk\ChromeProfile, then copies Chrome-Kiosk-Watchdog.vbs into C:\Kiosk.
5. It removes previous kiosk startup methods and registers the current-user Run entry named DashboardKiosk.
6. It starts the watchdog immediately. Wait about 15 seconds; Chrome should open automatically.
7. Log into the dashboard once if required, then reboot Windows once to verify startup after login.

What the Installer Changes

Area	Change
Folder	Creates C:\Kiosk and C:\Kiosk\ChromeProfile if they do not already exist.
Watchdog	Copies Chrome-Kiosk-Watchdog.vbs to C:\Kiosk\Chrome-Kiosk-Watchdog.vbs.
Old startup cleanup	Deletes the legacy scheduled task "Dashboard Chrome Kiosk", Startup-folder Dashboard-Kiosk.cmd and existing DashboardKiosk Run value.

Area	Change
Current-user startup	Adds HKCU\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Run\DashboardKiosk.
Startup command	wscript.exe "C:\Kiosk\Chrome-Kiosk-Watchdog.vbs"
Test start	Deletes the old kiosk.log and starts the watchdog immediately.

USER SCOPE	Because V4 uses HKCU, the automatic kiosk startup belongs to the Windows user that runs the installer. Installing it under a different account will register startup for that different account.

5. Practical Runtime Behavior

Chrome Discovery

At runtime, the watchdog searches for chrome.exe in these locations, in this order:

```
%LOCALAPPDATA%\Google\Chrome\Application\chrome.exe
%ProgramFiles%\Google\Chrome\Application\chrome.exe
%ProgramFiles(x86)%\Google\Chrome\Application\chrome.exe
```

If Chrome is not found, the watchdog writes "ERROR: Google Chrome was not found." to C:\Kiosk\kiosk.log and exits with code 2.

Chrome Launch Parameters

```
chrome.exe --kiosk --start-fullscreen --no-first-run --no-default-browser-check --noerrdialogs --disable-session-crashed-bubble --disable-translate --disable-features=TranslateUI --overscroll-history-navigation=0 --autoplay-policy=no-user-gesture-required --user-data-dir="C:\Kiosk\ChromeProfile" "https://web.itank.io/login/"
```

What the Watchdog Actually Monitors

PROCESS CHECK	The watchdog checks Windows processes for chrome.exe and confirms that the process command line contains C:\Kiosk\ChromeProfile. If no matching process is found, it starts Chrome again.

- The watchdog does not test dashboard HTTP status or page freshness.
- It does not test whether the Chrome renderer is frozen or visually blank.
- It does not restart Windows networking.
- It does not reboot Windows.
- It does not run as a Windows service; it runs in the logged-in user session through wscript.exe.

6. Persistent Chrome Profile and Dashboard Login

The kiosk uses a dedicated persistent profile:

```
C:\Kiosk\ChromeProfile
```

- Cookies, session data and the dashboard login state can persist across Chrome restarts and Windows reboots.
- If the dashboard requires authentication, log in once after installation if necessary.
- Do not delete C:\Kiosk\ChromeProfile if you want the existing browser cookies/login state retained.

SECURITY	The persistent Chrome profile can contain browser cookies and session data. Protect the Windows kiosk account and the C:\Kiosk folder appropriately.

7. Diagnostics and Support

Built-in Diagnostic Script

Run the diagnostic script from the extracted package folder:

```
TEST-KIOSK-V4.cmd
```

It reports the following items:

- Current Windows user (whoami).
- DashboardKiosk value in the current-user HKCU Run registry key.
- Presence of C:\Kiosk\Chrome-Kiosk-Watchdog.vbs.
- Known Google Chrome installation locations.
- Contents of C:\Kiosk\kiosk.log.
- Running chrome.exe processes and their command lines.
- It then starts the V4 watchdog, waits 15 seconds and displays the updated kiosk log.

Useful Manual Checks

```
reg query "HKCU\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Run" /v DashboardKiosk
dir "C:\Kiosk\Chrome-Kiosk-Watchdog.vbs"
type "C:\Kiosk\kiosk.log"
wmic process where "name='chrome.exe'" get ProcessId,CommandLine
```

8. Troubleshooting

Symptom	Check	Action
Chrome does not open after login	Check C:\Kiosk\kiosk.log and confirm the DashboardKiosk HKCU Run value exists.	Run TEST-KIOSK-V4.cmd.
Log says Chrome was not found	Chrome is not present in any of the three paths checked by the watchdog.	Install/repair Google Chrome in a supported location, then start the watchdog again.
Works when installer runs but not after reboot	The startup entry is per-user and Windows auto-login is external to this package.	Confirm the same kiosk account logs in and query the HKCU Run entry from that account.
Chrome closes and comes back	This is expected watchdog behavior when the matching kiosk Chrome process disappears.	No action unless it happens repeatedly.
Dashboard login is lost	The persistent profile may have been deleted/reset, or site cookies/session expired.	Log in again. Keep C:\Kiosk\ChromeProfile if persistence is required.
Dashboard page is frozen but Chrome stays open	V4 monitors process presence only, not page/renderer health.	Manually restart Chrome/watchdog and investigate the browser/site separately.
Multiple watchdog instances suspected	TEST/INSTALL can start another wscript watchdog; each instance uses the same profile check.	Sign out/reboot the kiosk user session, then allow normal HKCU startup to start one instance.

9. Remove Automatic Kiosk Startup

To remove the V4 automatic startup registration, run:

```
REMOVE-KIOSK-V4.cmd
```

The removal script deletes:

- HKCU Run value: DashboardKiosk.
- Legacy scheduled task: Dashboard Chrome Kiosk, if present.
- Legacy Startup-folder file: Dashboard-Kiosk.cmd, if present.

It intentionally does not delete the persistent Chrome profile:

```
C:\Kiosk\ChromeProfile
```

NOTE	Removing startup registration does not automatically stop an already running watchdog or Chrome session. Sign out/reboot, or close the running processes as part of maintenance if required.

10. Quick Technical Reference

Item	Value
Dashboard URL	https://web.itank.io/login/

Item	Value
Kiosk root	C:\Kiosk
Watchdog	C:\Kiosk\Chrome-Kiosk-Watchdog.vbs
Chrome profile	C:\Kiosk\ChromeProfile
Log file	C:\Kiosk\kiosk.log
Registry location	HKCU\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Run
Registry value	DashboardKiosk
Startup command	wscript.exe "C:\Kiosk\Chrome-Kiosk-Watchdog.vbs"
Initial watchdog delay	10 seconds
Process check interval	5 seconds
Installer	INSTALL-KIOSK-V4.cmd
Diagnostic	TEST-KIOSK-V4.cmd
Remove startup	REMOVE-KIOSK-V4.cmd

Verification Checklist

- [ ] V4 package extracted completely.
- [ ] Chrome is installed and dashboard URL is reachable.
- [ ] Installer was run under the intended kiosk Windows account.
- [ ] C:\Kiosk\Chrome-Kiosk-Watchdog.vbs exists.
- [ ] DashboardKiosk HKCU Run value exists.
- [ ] Chrome opens in kiosk/full-screen mode after the watchdog starts.
- [ ] C:\Kiosk\ChromeProfile retains required dashboard login state.
- [ ] Reboot test completed and kiosk starts after the Windows user logs in.
- [ ] TEST-KIOSK-V4.cmd output is available for troubleshooting if startup fails.

SUMMARY	Windows V4 is a current-user startup solution: Windows login -> HKCU Run -> VBScript watchdog -> Chrome kiosk. Its recovery scope is Chrome process relaunch only.

Source reviewed: Windows Dashboard Kiosk V4 package (INSTALL-KIOSK-V4.cmd, Chrome-Kiosk-Watchdog.vbs, TEST-KIOSK-V4.cmd, REMOVE-KIOSK-V4.cmd, README-KIOSK-V4.txt).